

Craig Hawkes

Curriculum Vitae · Lead Developer & Design Systems Architect

I build the system, the product that sits on top of it, and the gates that hold both to whatever I claimed. Eight years running my own studio, and a payment platform migrated without it going down.

Fifteen years across development and design, and it's the code that came first. I work in React, Next.js, TypeScript and .NET. I've built a 117-component enterprise design system on my own and gated its accessibility claim with tests rather than asserting it in a README, then delivered live Fiserv payment infrastructure on a PCI-DSS estate with mobile payments up 80% from launch. Six years as a qualified print and digital designer sits in the middle, trained separately. Nothing on this page is an assertion.

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Five people in my family and I'm the only one who isn't dyslexic. Mum, dad, both my sisters. That's why I check the contrast rather than claim it.

02 · EXPERIENCE

BPO Collections Ltd Full Stack Developer Sept 2025 - Apr 2026 · Contract

Rebuilt the payment flow on Fiserv and led the platform's migration off legacy ASP.NET onto typed Next.js, with the estate trading throughout.

80% more mobile payments since launch

- 70% of that increase came through Apple Pay, across both single and continuous payments, on a Fiserv integration built end to end.
- Reduced a four-screen payment flow to one interaction with no loss of compliance coverage, worth roughly £500,000 a month more through the platform.
- Migrated off ASP.NET with a PCI-DSS estate of 97+ stored procedures live throughout. The platform never came down.
- Planned and ran the production cutover: three runbooks split by server to enforce ordering, and a backout procedure written before deployment rather than during it.

Next.js · TypeScript · ASP.NET · SQL Server · Fiserv

inclusive.io Co-founder & Design Systems Engineer Feb 2024 - Present · Part Time / Co-Founder

An enterprise design system and the applicant tracking product built on top of it, delivered single-handedly, with the accessibility claim enforced by gates rather than asserted in a document.

117 components · 26 ATS workflows · 0 axe violations · Solo build

- Every component ships with a unit test, a Storybook story and a documentation page, and all of it was delivered solo across two full rebuilds.
- Took a WCAG 2.2 AAA claim from an assertion to a register: 4 criteria enforced by test, 13 met, 3 exceptions published, 0 outstanding. 0 axe violations across 174 routes.
- Ran the build to a documented seven-phase framework, and produced 47 supporting documents. 18 research papers, 3 audit reports and a 14-document handover pack.
- Built with agent tooling throughout, held to the same gates as any other contributor. Rules and MCP servers live in the repo, and nothing merges unread.

React · Next.js · TypeScript · Tailwind · HeroUI · React Aria · Turborepo

DesignBuddy UK Founder & Full-Stack Developer Oct 2017 - Present · Business

Founded and still run an independent studio, taking clients from the first conversation through to deployment and the support that follows it.

8+ years · 50+ clients

- Build and ship production front ends in React, Next.js and Tailwind, plus custom WordPress themes, Shopify storefronts and PHP back ends.
- Take clients from first conversation through to deployment and post-launch support, rather than handing off at the design file.

React · Next.js · TypeScript · Tailwind · Shopify · WordPress · PHP

Paul McFadden Wealth Head of Web Dec 2022 - Jan 2024 · Full Time

Ran the web department for a property education group and the partner businesses selling alongside it, with every funnel, course platform and event page in the group coming through the team.

- Personally accountable for over £10m of revenue generated through the direct web funnels and event pages the department ran.
- Hired three of the team and co-managed the seven: five videographers, a junior web designer and a social media intern.
- Built four course-launch platforms end to end in WordPress and custom PHP, including ClickFunnels and Klaviyo integration.

- Shipped full-stack to WCAG accessibility standards, and rebuilt the campaign infrastructure: open rates up 60%, cold-outreach replies up 27%.

WordPress · PHP · JavaScript · HTML/CSS · Klaviyo · ClickFunnels

EARLIER

TMD Media Senior Web Designer Aug - Dec 2022

Built conversion-focused sites and marketing systems across an agency client portfolio, three or four concurrently, to fixed deadlines.

- Developed custom WordPress themes and plugins in PHP, moving clients off template-builder setups onto purpose-built front ends.

NOVAVAPES Graphic Designer Oct 2016 - Sept 2022

Sole designer for six years as the company scaled from startup to established brand, owning every surface from packaging to the e-commerce storefront.

- Designed and maintained the e-commerce storefront and product catalogues alongside the full brand system.
- Recruited and developed an apprentice from junior to running the social channel outright.

03 · SELECTED WORK

inclusive.io Design System

V1 core on npm as @hawkbass/inclusive-design-core under MIT, with exports, types and client directives checked against the built tarballs.

Quoin: a baseline grid engine for the web

Fits a design to a baseline grid before the CSS is written, and corrects a page that has already rendered when there is one. Public, MIT, no dependencies. Benchmarked against nine design systems including my own, which came last and was published that way.

04 · CAPABILITIES

ENGINEERING

- Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind
- Fiserv, Open Banking, PCI-DSS
- ASP.NET modernisation

RELEASE & PLATFORM

- Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD gates
- Vercel, preview and production
- Cutover and rollback runbooks

DESIGN SYSTEMS

- W3C DTCG token architecture
- OKLCH colour and component APIs
- ATS domain workflows

RESEARCH & DOCUMENTATION

- Seven-phase design system framework
- Specification and handover packs
- Standards read first-hand, not second

ACCESSIBILITY

- WCAG 2.2 AA gated, AAA where achievable
- React Aria interaction patterns
- axe-core and Playwright verification

DELIVERY

- DesignBuddy: 50+ clients, 8+ years
- Brand, web, and product builds
- Discovery through launch

05 · SKILLS

FRONTEND CORE

React · Next.js · TypeScript

FRAMEWORKS & LIBRARIES

Angular · React Aria / React Stately · Radix UI

DESIGN SYSTEMS

Design Tokens (W3C DTCG) · OKLCH Colour · Atomic Design

RELEASE, CI/CD & PLATFORM

Git · GitHub / GitHub Actions · CI/CD pipelines

BACKEND & INFRASTRUCTURE

Node.js · ASP.NET (VB.NET & C#) · SQL Server / T-SQL

TESTING & ACCESSIBILITY

WCAG 2.2 (AA gated, AAA where it holds) · axe-core / jest-axe · Playwright

RESEARCH & DOCUMENTATION

Technical documentation · Design system specification · Competitive and standards research

DESIGN & CREATIVE

UI/UX Design · Adobe Creative Suite · Brand Identity

AI & AGENT SYSTEMS

LLM providers (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google) · Prompt & context design · MCP servers